Exploration rule – Weather and extreme climates · DM guide (table rules)

Weather changes mood and rules: rain, wind, fog, snow, extreme cold and heat, altitude. The SRD has few rules: the effects below are **table rules** inspired by the Dungeon Master's Guide.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. Heavy rain: **Disadvantage** on Perception.
2. Strong wind: **Disadvantage** on ranged attacks.
3. Extreme cold: **Con DC 10** per hour.
4. Extreme heat: **Con DC 5** (+1 per hour).

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 no longer details weather: we rely on the Dungeon Master's Guide and the **Exhaustion** condition.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't say how to decide the day's weather. Fix: the DM rolls 1d20 (see table) or picks it by region.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can announce the weather as a clue to the place: ashes, smell of rain, mist.

Step 1 – Choose:

Set the day's weather (table or choice).

Step 2 – Effects:

Heavy rain: Disadvantage on Perception, open flames out. Strong wind: Disadvantage on ranged attacks.

Step 3 – Cold:

Per hour unprotected: Con save DC 10; failure: 1 Exhaustion.

Step 4 – Heat:

Per hour: Con DC 5 (+1 per hour); failure: 1 Exhaustion. Without water, the DC rises.

Step 5 – Altitude:

Above 10,000 ft, each hour of travel counts double.

Example: on the snowy pass, the group faces extreme cold: Lira fails her Con DC 10 and gains 1 Exhaustion.

1d20	Weather	Effect
1–14	Clear	None
15–17	Heavy rain	Disadvantage on Perception
18	Strong wind	Disadvantage on ranged
19	Fog	Lightly obscured
20	Storm	Shelter or Exhaustion

⚠ Common questions:

What DC for cold?

10 per hour.

And heat?

5, +1 per hour.

What does heavy rain do?

Disadvantage on Perception.

What does strong wind do?

Disadvantage on ranged attacks.

What effect at altitude?

Slower travel.

How do I protect myself?

Clothing, shelter or a spell.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Immunity

Who is immune? **Option**: cold or fire resistance.

Fog

Lightly obscured? **Option**: yes, Disadvantage on Perception.

Storm

Must we shelter? **Option**: yes, or take damage.

Snow

Difficult terrain? **Option**: yes, doubled movement.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Exhaustion

Each level subtracts 2 from d20 rolls.

Table rule

Most of these effects aren't in the SRD.

Travel

See the Travel and Exploration sheet.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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